

Topic Area 1: Plan characters and comics

Teaching content

Exemplification

1.1 Character features and conventions

Types of character

- ☐ Cartoon
- ☐ Doodle
- ☐ Photorealistic
- ☐ Geometric shapes
- ☐ Minimalist/simplification

Features of characters

- ☐ Colour
- ☐ Shape
- ☐ Proportion

Characteristics and conventions

- ☐ Digital characters' physical and non-physical characteristics
 - personality
 - character trope (hero, villain)
 - superpower
- ☐ Digital characters' facial characteristics and how they are used to convey emotion
 - distortion
 - proportion
 - exaggeration
 - anthropomorphism
 - simplification
- ☐ Use of visual styles to create distinctive and recognisable characters

To include:

- Different types of character and how they are used within comics

To include:

- How different design style options are determined by sector, purpose and audience
- Using colour to suit the target audience, and to indicate genre and style
- Using shape and proportion to create character 'tropes'

Does not include:

- Researching/investigating specific characters and their characteristics

To include:

- Conventions of types of character linked to their purpose and target audience
- Representing non-physical characteristics in character design
- Representing emotion and personality through facial characteristics e.g. eye size and proximity, eyebrow placement, mouth position and proportion
- The distinguishing features of iconic visual styles created by Marvel, DC Comics, Shultz, Herge and Disney, and in types of comics like Manga

Does not include:

- History of comics
- Character studies